

Zenabu Suboi
Hope Baptist Church,
P. O. Box 12914,
Accra.

6th October 2025.

The Visa Section,
Canadian Embassy,
42 Independence Avenue,
Accra, Ghana.

Dear Visa Officer,

MOTIVATION FOR APPLYING FOR A VISITOR'S VISA

I am writing to respectfully request a visa to attend the American Society of Tropical Medicine and Hygiene (ASTMH) Annual Meeting, scheduled for November 9-13, 2025, at the Metro Toronto Convention Centre, Toronto, Ontario, Canada. This 5-day meeting brings together researchers, professors, public health officials, government representatives, military personnel, travel medicine specialists, and practicing physicians to share research findings and expertise in addressing global health challenges.

I am currently a PhD student in Epidemiology at the University of Basel, Switzerland, affiliated with the Swiss Tropical and Public Health Institute (Swiss TPH). My PhD follows the “sandwich model,” which allows me to conduct part of my research in my home country, Ghana. Earlier this year, I spent several months in Switzerland working on the first objective of my PhD, the results of which I will be presenting at the ASTMH conference in Toronto. I am presently in Ghana to continue my research and will return to Switzerland in February 2026; therefore, I am applying for this visa from Ghana.

My research, titled “*Uncertainty Quantification of Agent-based Models with Application to Malaria Intervention Modeling*,” focuses on improving the understanding of malaria transmission dynamics and guiding effective intervention strategies. These insights are crucial in the fight against malaria in sub-Saharan Africa.

During my master’s studies at Stellenbosch University in South Africa, I had the privilege of attending an international infectious disease conference (Epidemics) in South Carolina, United States, where I presented a project “*Modeling Vaccine Delivery Strategies for Rabies Elimination in Rural Western Kenya*.” That experience allowed me to engage with senior disease modelers whose mentorship and influence played a key role in shaping my current PhD path. I believe the upcoming meeting in Canada presents a similar opportunity to advance my research and career while contributing to the global health community.

My previous academic travels, as detailed in the Schedule_1 form, have greatly enriched my professional development. I have always complied fully with visa regulations and returned to Ghana after completing each program or training. This demonstrates my commitment to respecting the terms of all granted stays.

My institution has already booked my flights and accommodation for the conference period, ensuring that my travel plans are well arranged. In addition, I intend to visit a close friend (Emmanuella Seyram Avornyoh) for one day after the conference before returning to Ghana.

I therefore kindly request your assistance in granting me a visa to participate in this important conference. Attending will allow me to present my research to the world's largest gathering of tropical medicine and global health professionals, foster academic collaboration, and strengthen research partnerships between Ghana, Switzerland, and the global community.

Thank you very much for considering my application. I would be happy to provide any further information or documentation to support my request.

Yours sincerely,



Zenabu Suboi.

Attachments:

1. PhD admission letter
2. Sandwich PhD regulation
3. Confirmation letter from Swiss Tropical and Public Health Institute
4. National identification card
5. Flight details
6. Hotel accommodation for conference period
7. Emmanuella's address details in Canada